

KowaGuru Technology Limited

INTERNAL MEMORANDUM · CONFIDENTIAL

TO Aliyu Yahaya — Chief Executive Officer
FROM Chief Technology Officer
DATE 18 August 2026
RE KAFRIADA CORE — my recommended starting scope, for your review and feedback
REF KAF 000 – GDOC, Version 1.0 Draft

What I suggest we build first, and why

Aliyu,

I have gone through the KAF 000 document end to end — all 244 pages. Before anything else: the thinking behind this is strong. The core idea, one permanent verified identity for every African athlete, is the right wedge into this market, and nobody else is holding it. The problem is real, the four-phase structure makes sense, and the depth of the document shows how much work has gone into it. I want to protect that idea, and that is exactly why I am writing this memo.

My concern is not with the vision. It is with the size of the first bite. This memo lays out what I believe we should build first, my reasons, and the numbers I want us to judge it by. You are the brain behind this idea, so before I draw a single architecture diagram, I need your feedback on this direction.

1. My honest read of Phase 1 as documented

The document calls Phase 1 an MVP, but what it describes is five products launching together: an identity and verification system, a full club management suite with contracts and automated transfer revenue-splitting, a medical records system, a six-category marketplace with three payment gateways, and an admin and finance platform — across a mobile app, a web app, and an admin portal, in 24 weeks, with a team of 10 to 12 engineers.

I have three problems with committing to that as our first move:

- Money.** The document itself says we have no external sponsor yet. The plan asks us to fund a 10–12 person team for six months before we learn anything about whether the market will pay. Under the current sprint plan, payments only go live around week 15. That means our single most important question — will an athlete or a parent actually pay ₦5,000 for Stage 2 verification? — stays unanswered until most of the budget is already spent.
- Regulation.** Phase 1 as written handles children's data, medical records, and payments all at once. Each of those alone is a serious compliance workload under NDPR. For a platform whose

entire promise is trust, one misstep on a minor's medical data could finish us before we start. I do not want us learning three compliance regimes simultaneously in our first six months.

3. **Focus.** A team building five modules at once builds none of them well. Our advantage is the identity system. Everything else in the ecosystem — Compete, Edu, Enterprise — stands on it. If the KUID is solid, the rest has a foundation. If it is shaky, nothing above it matters.

2. What I recommend instead: lead with the identity wedge

I suggest we build the smallest version of KAFRIADA that completes one full loop of real value:

An athlete registers, receives a permanent KUID and a shareable QR profile, pays ₦5,000 to get verified — and a club builds its official roster out of those verified identities.

That is registration, KUID generation, the public QR profile, Stage 1 and Stage 2 verification with Paystack payment, the guardian consent flow for under-18s, a simple club registration with an invite-by-KUID roster, and the admin approval queue behind it. One responsive web application that works on any Android phone, plus the admin views. Six roles live at launch instead of twenty-eight — though the access-control design supports all twenty-eight, so nothing is rebuilt later.

Every piece of this comes straight from your document. The KUID format, the three-stage verification framework, the sport-agnostic data model, the audit logging — all built exactly as specified. This is not a different product. It is the first slice of the same product, chosen so that the market gives us an answer quickly and cheaply.

The shareable profile is also our marketing engine. Every athlete who registers gets a link and a QR code worth showing off. They spread it themselves — on WhatsApp, on jerseys, at trials. That is customer acquisition we do not have to pay for.

3. What I am deliberately holding back, and my reason for each

FEATURE	DECISION	MY REASON
Medical records	Next release	The heaviest legal exposure in the whole document — children's health data — and it teaches us nothing about demand. We build it properly, with a dedicated compliance effort, once we are funded.
Transfers, wallets, revenue splits	Later phase	A transfer market needs verified athletes and buying clubs on both sides. At launch we have neither. Holding and splitting other people's money may also raise CBN licensing questions we should not face before funding.
Marketplace (all categories)	Next release	Same problem: listings with no audience. A simple trials and opportunities board is the first thing we add once verified athletes exist for organisations to want.
Stage 3 verification	Designed for, piloted later	Stage 3 depends on StatVest equipment and trained officers on the ground. That is an operations programme, not a software sprint. The database is built ready for it; we pilot it manually in one state when the time comes.
Scout subscriptions	Next release	A scout pays ₦100,000 a year for access to verified talent. Until we have thousands of verified athletes, we have nothing to sell him. Sequence matters.
Native mobile app	Next release	A responsive web app reaches every Android browser on day one, with one codebase and no app-store delays. The document's own Chapter 24 actually lists native apps as out of scope for the MVP — I am agreeing with that page of it.
Heavy infrastructure	Later phase	Elasticsearch, microservices, GraphQL and three payment gateways are sized for hundreds of thousands of users we do not have yet. We start with one well-structured system on PostgreSQL and Paystack, built along the same module boundaries the document defines, so splitting it later is straightforward.

Nothing on this list is cancelled. Everything is sequenced. The difference is that under my plan, each of these gets built with revenue evidence behind it — which also makes every one of them easier to fund.

4. Cost and timeline, side by side

	PHASE 1 AS DOCUMENTED	MY RECOMMENDATION
Team	10–12 engineers	4–5 people
Time to first users	24 weeks to public launch	10–12 weeks to closed pilot
Pilot	1,000 athletes, 50 clubs (week 21)	2–3 states, 20–30 clubs, 2,000–5,000 athletes (around week 16)
Spend before market evidence	Essentially the full budget	Roughly a quarter to a third of it
If the market says no	We find out after the money is gone	We adjust price or channel with most of our capital intact

5. How we will know it worked

I want us to agree on the pass marks now, before we start, so the decision after the pilot is made by numbers and not by mood. Eight weeks after the pilot opens:

MEASURE	PASS MARK	WHAT IT PROVES
Stage 1 registrations	2,000 or more	Grassroots demand is real
Paid Stage 2 conversions	5% or more (100+ payments)	The revenue model holds
Active clubs	25+, each with 15+ rostered athletes	Clubs are our distribution channel
Verification turnaround	Under 24 hours, sustained	Our operations match our promise
Profile shares per week	Growing week on week	Athletes are marketing us themselves

If we clear these marks, our investor conversation changes completely. We stop pitching a document and start showing a hundred-plus Nigerians who paid us for verification and twenty-five clubs running their rosters on our platform every week. That evidence funds the rest of Phase 1 — Care, the Marketplace, the mobile app — and puts Compete, Edu and Enterprise on solid ground. If we fall short, we still hold most of our capital and an honest answer about what to change.

6. One housekeeping item on the document

Before development starts, I want one week to tidy the specification with the team. The current draft has a few internal conflicts we should resolve on paper rather than in code: two different chapters are both numbered 10, chapters O1 and O5 are duplicates of each other and O4 is missing, Chapter 24 describes a second MVP that does not match Chapters 5 and 13, and the revenue targets differ between chapters (₦500M–₦1B in one place, ₦1B–₦3B in another, ₦8.5B by Year 5 in a third — and

I believe the “8,000,000 clubs” figure in Chapter 16 is meant to read 8,000). Small things, but engineers build exactly what the paper says, so the paper has to agree with itself.

7. What I need from you

This is your idea, and I will not move on this without your input. Specifically, I would like your view on three things:

1. Do you agree with leading with identity and clubs, and holding back medical, transfers and the marketplace until after the pilot?
2. Are you comfortable with the pass marks in section 5 as our go/no-go line for funding the rest of Phase 1?
3. Which two or three states, and which clubs in your network, should we approach for the pilot?
Your relationships will decide how fast the first thousand athletes arrive.

Once you have given me your feedback and we have settled the scope, my next deliverable to you is the full system and solution architecture for it: the module map, the core database design around the KUID, the verification workflow, the payment flow, and the deployment setup — sized for the pilot, with a clear path to the scale in your document.

I am ready to walk you through any part of this whenever suits you.

Respectfully,

Chief Technology Officer
KowaGuru Technology Limited